Lab No. 05:

Working with Blend, Merge and Flatten Layers

Objective

Understand the difference between Merge Layers and Flatten Image.

Theory

Blend Layers

Definition

Layer Blending is the process of combining two or more layers using Blend Modes. Blend Modes determine how the pixels of one layer interact with the pixels of another layer.

Common Blend Modes

Blend Mode	Function
Normal	Displays the original layer without blending.
Multiply	Makes the image darker.
Screen	Makes the image brighter.
Overlay	Increases contrast.
Soft Light	Creates soft lighting effects.

Purpose

- Combine images.
- Create lighting effects.
- Improve contrast.
- Produce photo manipulations.

Merge Layers

Definition

Merge Layers combines selected visible layers into one layer while leaving other layers unchanged.

Purpose

- Reduce the number of layers.
- Organize projects.
- Simplify editing.

Flatten Image

Definition

Flatten Image merges all visible layers, including text and adjustment layers, into a single Background layer.

Purpose

- Reduce file size.
- Prepare the image for export.
- Finalize a project.

Difference

Merge Layers	Flatten Image
Merges selected layers	Merges all visible layers
Other layers remain separate	Only one Background layer remains
Editing is still partially possible	Layer editing is no longer possible

Steps

Blend Layers

1. Open Photoshop.
2. Open two images.
3. Place one image over the other.
4. Select the top layer.
5. Change the Blend Mode to:
    - Multiply
    - Screen
    - Overlay
6. Observe the results.
7. Save the file.

Merge Layers

1. Select two or more layers.
2. Right-click.
3. Choose **Merge Layers**.
4. Save the file.

Flatten Image

1. Go to **Layer → Flatten Image**.
2. Save the image in JPEG format.

Lab Tasks

Task 1: Create a poster using **at least two images** and apply **any two Blend Modes**.

Task 2: Merge the design layers and then flatten the image.

Result:

Conclusion: